

JOSEPH CUFFNEY

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Professional Summary

Senior software engineer with 10+ years turning ambiguous business problems into production systems — working directly with stakeholders, owning the stack end to end, and shipping 0-to-1 products fast without sacrificing quality. Paired with AI, that experience lets me ship in days what used to take weeks — for my teams and customers.

Education

Rochester Institute of Technology · B.S. Computer Science · Rochester, NY

Experience

Coinbase · Senior Software Engineer

January 2022 – Present · Remote

Capital Formation (Raise)

- Led a 10-engineer team to launch a capital formation platform enabling IPOs, private equity, and token sales.
- Worked cross-functionally with product, design, marketing, legal, ops, and business to define and refine our solution.
- Delivered the product and went to production in 2 months — raising \$250M+ for our first issuer.

International Exchange

- Led the initial advanced trading build-out for perpetual futures, opening previously unserved international markets.
- Translated legal and regulatory requirements into product decisions, shipping in step with the exchange build-out.
- Owned global rollout — including observability, scaling, and feedback sessions — driving \$1B+ in first-year volume.

GraphQL Federation

- Led a company-wide GraphQL re-architecture, replacing the monolith with a federated graph each team could own.
- Enabled teams to ship faster by owning their own subgraphs, decoupling releases from the shared monolith.
- Built the first subgraph (Go, gqlgen) as the reference, then guided engineers across teams through their migrations.

Nike (Valiant Labs) · Senior Software Engineer III

June 2018 – December 2021 · Portland, OR / Remote

Cultivator

- Built what became Nike By You — a marketplace where 100+ creators sold 500k+ shoes in 1 week.
- Designed an experience that yielded a consistent 13% conversion rate compared to a ~1% industry standard.
- Met directly with creators to understand their needs and motivations, shaping the product around their success.

Nike (Valiant Labs) · Lead Software Engineer (contract)

August 2017 – June 2018 · Portland, OR

Tandem Personal Training

- Solo engineer testing whether trainer accountability could get more people active, driving the Nike flywheel.
- Met with Nike Master Trainer Ryan Flaherty and clients at events we hosted, shaping the product for both sides.
- Owned the build end to end, going from zero to launch in 5 weeks with 100+ trainers onboarded across Portland.

The Program · Technical Lead

October 2015 – August 2017 · Portland, OR

- Led client engagements end to end at a digital agency — scoping, estimating, and delivering across varied stacks.
- Worked directly with clients to turn requirements into shipped products, while mentoring engineers on the team.

Independent Projects

Jarvis · AI Voice Assistant · 2026

- Built a household voice assistant on AWS — Nova 2 Sonic for speech, with deeper tasks delegated to Claude agents.
- Integrated the systems it acts on: Home Assistant, Gmail, Calendar, S3 Vectors RAG, and MCP tools.
- Shipped in 2 weeks on CloudFormation with deploys on every push, and a monthly cap bounding model spend.

Assistant · Local-First AI Assistant · 2026

- Rule-based NLP triage, then Laya, a self-hosted ModernBERT decision model, labels route, tone, and task.
- A decision model routes and LLM agents do the work; calibrated confidence sets when to act or escalate to a human.
- Multi-agent tasks: a planner breaks work into steps, researcher agents execute, and a reporter summarizes results.

Orca(stration) AI · LDAP + Agents · 2026

- Building a platform that makes AI agents first-class members of the org chart — Rust microservices on Kubernetes.
- Extended LDAP so agents are encoded into the company structure rather than living as employee workflows.
- Guardrailed reasoning loop escalates to humans; x402 micropayment budgets keep agent spend and ROI measurable.

LLM Gateway · Unified Model Gateway · 2026

- Built a LiteLLM gateway for every app in my lab — local llama.cpp models first, Claude on Bedrock as fallback.
- Per-consumer keys and spend/usage tracking in Postgres make each app’s model usage and cost visible.
- Self-hosted speech-to-text and text-to-speech, chosen by measured time-to-first-byte and real-time factor.

Homelab · GPU Inference Cluster · 2026

- Passed an RTX PRO 5000 (72 GB) through Proxmox into a Talos Kubernetes node that serves all local inference.
- Split VRAM into 18 × 4 GB units with NVIDIA time-slicing, per-tenant budgets, and priority classes for preemption.
- Sized models to fit the card — gpt-oss-20b, Qwen3 Coder 30B, embeddings, Parakeet STT, and Chatterbox TTS.

Rally · Community Platform · 2022 – 2024

- Part-time lead engineer building web and mobile apps that bring people together around shared interests.
- Evolved the product across market segments — from motorcycling to surfing — as we tested for fit.
- Pivoted to brand community, partnering with Patagonia, Columbia, and Nike on customer events.

On Set! · Set-Location Discovery App · 2020 – 2022

- Co-founded a film set-location app: 2,000+ locations mapped, 200 small-business partners, 1,000 MAU in year one.
- Built relationships with local businesses and led marketing while building the web and React Native apps.

Skills

DELIVERY	Stakeholder discovery	User research	Requirements → solution	Scoping	Rollout & feedback					
AI & AGENTS	Claude / OpenAI / Grok	MCP	Tool use	Agent orchestration	RAG	Evals				
FRAMEWORKS	Claude Agent SDK	rig (Rust)	LangChain	LangGraph						
HARNESSES	Claude Code	Codex	OpenCode	Hermes						
NLP	Intent classification (ModernBERT)	Semantic analysis & search	Embeddings	Speech (STT/TTS)						
MODELS	Open-weight models (gpt-oss, Qwen, Gemma)	llama.cpp	Ollama	AWS Bedrock	LiteLLM					
LANGUAGES	TypeScript	JavaScript	Python	Go	Rust	Swift	Kotlin	C/C++	Java	Bash
WEB & APIS	React	React Native	Node.js	GraphQL (Federation)	gRPC	REST				
CLOUD & INFRA	AWS	Kubernetes	Argo CD	Terraform	CloudFormation	Docker	Proxmox	Datadog		
HARDWARE	GPU passthrough	VRAM partitioning	NVIDIA time-slicing	Model sizing	ESP32 (Rust)	PCB design				
INTEGRATIONS	Stripe	Webhooks	Google APIs (Gmail, Calendar)	Home Assistant	n8n					
DATA	Postgres	SurrealDB	DynamoDB	Elasticsearch	Snowflake					